REFERENCES & GUIDE

jamesmcquiggan.com





Building Speaking Confidence

- Practice, Practice, Practice
- Know your material
- Know the audience
- Know the room
- Visualize yourself giving the speech
- Concentrate on the message, not the medium
- Don't apologize – Sorry
- Realize that people want you to succeed
- Relax / Breathe
- Gaining experience = GAINING CONFIDENCE

Mastering Body Language

- Eye Contact
- Move, but with purpose
- Eliminate distracting mannerisms
- Be natural, spontaneous & conversational
- Let your body mirror your feelings
- Build self-confidence through preparation
- Practice, practice, practice

Develop Vocal Variety

- Pitch
- Duration
- Pause
- Volume (Loudness)
- Voice and Image
- Avoid Crutch words
- Practice, practice, practice

PowerPoint Tips

- Contrast – light on dark
- Don't read the slides
- Make your text large
- Choose easy to read colors
- Bullet points not a sentence
- Keep the flying to Superman
- Avoid eye charts – 7 bullets max
- Don't display your text all at once!
- Use Visuals to Present Data
- Don't click and speak – speak & click

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Hook Your First 30 Seconds

Grab attention before you introduce yourself. Pick one:

- Ask a question (or a series of them)
- Startling fact or statistic
- "Imagine…" – make them picture it
- Tell a short story
- A "What if…?" scenario
- A compelling sound bite

The 3-Question Spine

Every talk should answer these, in order:

- Who are you?
- Why should I care?
- How do you solve my problem?

Source: Grundei Coaching · grundeicoaching.com · meridithgrundei.com

Resources

- Toastmasters International – find a local chapter
- Meridith Grundei – TikTok / YouTube – Online Community
- Neil Gordon – TikTok / Newsletter – 30 days of tips
- "Talk Like TED" by Carmine Gallo
- "Presentation Zen" by Garr Reynolds – slide design
- "Made to Stick" by Chip & Dan Heath – memorable messaging.